



The Red Queen

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Book Summary

This title looks at a space-themed story about characters Pat and Mat who have crash landed their rocket ship on a red planet. They encounter a red queen. In the book, the reader is introduced to new phonics sounds. Detailed and vibrant illustrations depict and help the text explain some basic story information about each page.

This book follows the Beanstalk Books (Letters & Sounds) Phase 3 progression and focuses on learning the next 25 graphemes that are taught in this sequence.

Skills and Strategies

This book builds on decodable reading strategies for high/low readers. The book has been written using a strictly controlled vocabulary. Text uses only **decodable regular words** (according to the week by week progression of Letters & Sounds) along with **'tricky words'** or **'Common Exception Words'** (CEWs). Common Exception Words are frequently used words that are not decodable at this phase.

Phase 3 - Phonics

j	v	w	x	y	z	zz	qu	ch
sh	th	ng	ai	ee	igh	oa	oi	oo
ow	ar	air	ear	er	ur	or	ure	

Tricky Words:

the, go, is, to, onto, no, I, of, there, she, they, me, you, all, assures, opens, door

This book also supports other key reading strategies:

- Recognising the relationship between words and illustrations;
- Pointing one-to-one at each word to ensure an appropriate match;
- Vocabulary and word study.

This book also supports key comprehension strategies:

- Predicting the meanings of new or unfamiliar words from the context of the story;
- Recognising the relationship between letters and their sounds;
- Summarising the main ideas of the story.

Introducing the Text

Open up the discussion about the front cover illustration and make connections with the children's prior knowledge. Prompt discussions by using the vocabulary in the book.

What does the title of the story tell you about the front cover image?

Describe the characters and imagery on the front cover. Where is the setting?

Read the title and the name of the author to the group. Read aloud any common exception words from the front inner cover.

Reading the Text

Pages 2 and 3 – Explain where to begin reading, and ask the student to point to each word as you read aloud together. The lights go down on the rocket ship. There is red fog in the air and the red queen waits to meet Pat and Mat. Review and sound out the new Phase 3 graphemes you have learned in the words as you go.

Pages 4 and 5 – On these pages, Pat assures Mat that they should get off the ship. Pat opens the door. Tab the cat hugs onto Mat.

Pages 6 and 7 – The red queen is the Queen of Mars. She sings to them.

Page 8 – The illustration on the final page shows the kids looking concerned. The red queen will not let them go until they sing a long song. Which words in this book feature the 'ng' grapheme that you have learned?

Students can now read the book independently. At the end of the story, go over the text and illustrations again and discuss what is happening on each page.

Revisiting the Text

As a group, refer back to the table in the front inner cover and identify the words in the story that use the new graphemes being taught in Phase 3.

To start with, identify as many Phase 3 graphemes as you can in the words in the text. For example, 'igh' in words like: lights, sight, tight, or 'qu' in the word 'queen'.

Look at the use of punctuation in the story. Can you find the pages with a question mark or exclamation mark in the text? Are there any speech marks in this text?

Following Up

Use the BLM for this story, the students can learn more about the introduction of different types of letter sounds (phonics) being used in the text of the story.